FIGHTERBASE

Gluten-free

Diet guide

No wheat, barley or rye.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Gluten-free**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Gluten-free?

Leaves out gluten, a protein in wheat, barley and rye. Essential for people with coeliac disease; some others feel better without it.

Where it comes from

Gluten-free eating began as the medical treatment for coeliac disease, where gluten damages the gut. Some people also avoid gluten for wheat allergy or non-coeliac gluten sensitivity. Gluten is a protein in wheat, barley and rye.

The main ideas

1. Avoid wheat, barley and rye and anything made from them (including spelt, kamut, semolina, couscous, bulgur, seitan).
2. Oats are only safe if labelled gluten-free because of cross-contamination.
3. Naturally gluten-free foods are plentiful: meat, fish, eggs, dairy, fruit, vegetables, rice, potatoes, maize, quinoa, legumes.
4. Cross-contamination counts for coeliacs: crumbs, shared toasters and shared fryers.
5. Do not self-diagnose: gluten-free eating before testing can hide coeliac disease.

Who it suits

- People diagnosed with coeliac disease or wheat allergy
- People advised by their doctor to avoid gluten

Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:

- You think you might have coeliac disease (get tested before cutting gluten out)
- You have unexplained tiredness, stomach trouble or weight loss
- You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Carbs are easy: rice, potatoes, maize, quinoa, gluten-free oats, gluten-free pasta and bread.
- Gluten-free breads and cereals are often lower in fibre, iron and B vitamins, so choose fortified products where you can.
- Pack your own food for competitions and travel. Gluten can hide in energy bars and supplements.
- Check protein powders and gels for gluten.

> Rice, potatoes and gluten-free oats cover fuel easily.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Fibre
gut health
Where: vegetables, fruit, beans, brown rice, quinoa, gluten-free oats

Iron
oxygen carrying
Where: meat, beans, lentils, fortified gluten-free cereals

B vitamins
energy
Where: meat, eggs, dairy, fortified products

Calcium
bones, important if untreated coeliac disease
Where: dairy, fortified alternatives, sardines

Common mistakes

- Assuming 'wheat-free' means gluten-free (barley and rye still contain it)
- Shared toasters, chopping boards and fryers
- Assuming oats are safe without a gluten-free label
- Relying on processed gluten-free biscuits and breads

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Look for 'gluten-free' (20 parts per million or less in UK and EU rules)
- Contains: wheat, barley, rye, malt, brewer's yeast
- Doubtful: soy sauce (usually wheat), stock cubes, sauces, malt vinegar, some sausages, some crisps

Eating out

- Tell staff you need gluten-free, not just that you prefer it.
- Ask about separate fryers and surfaces.
- Choose simple grilled meat or fish with vegetables and potatoes or rice.
- Take your own bread for sandwiches if needed.

Easy swaps

Bread	→	Gluten-free bread or corn tortillas
Pasta	→	Gluten-free pasta, rice noodles
Soy sauce	→	Tamari (certified gluten-free)
Flour for sauces	→	Cornflour or gluten-free flour
Oats	→	Certified gluten-free oats

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Eggs on gluten-free toast	Jacket potato with tuna and salad	Chicken, rice, vegetables
Tue	Gluten-free porridge, berries	Rice bowl with salmon and avocado	Beef stir-fry with rice noodles
Wed	Greek yoghurt, fruit, nuts	Soup (check stock), corn tortillas	Roast chicken, potatoes, vegetables
Thu	Omelette with vegetables	Quinoa salad with feta	Turkey burgers, no bun, wedges
Fri	Smoothie and gluten-free granola	Chicken and rice soup	Fish, new potatoes, green beans
Sat	Pancakes (gluten-free flour)	Leftover chicken salad	Chilli with rice
Sun	Full breakfast (check sausages), no toast	Cold meats, salad, crisps (check)	Roast beef, roast potatoes, vegetables

Snacks

Fruit · Nuts · Rice cakes · Popcorn · Boiled eggs · Yoghurt · Hummus and vegetables

Shopping list

Meat, fish, eggs · Dairy · Fruit and vegetables · Rice, potatoes, maize, quinoa, buckwheat · Certified gluten-free oats, bread and pasta · Tamari · Gluten-free flour and cornflour

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Is gluten-free healthier?

Only if you have coeliac disease or another gluten-related condition. Otherwise, there is no proven benefit.

Are oats gluten-free?

They contain a different protein (avenin) that many coeliacs tolerate, but regular oats are often cross-contaminated. Choose certified gluten-free oats, and ask your doctor.

Can I drink beer?

Standard beer contains barley. Look for certified gluten-free beer.

Further reading

Coeliac UK; NHS; British Dietetic Association.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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